CIIT
COLLEGE OF ARTS AND TECHNOLOGY

METROStay

Live closer. STAY longer.

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Executive Summary

Metro Stay is a long-term rental platform designed to solve the chaotic and often unsafe rental landscape in the Philippines, especially in urban hubs like Metro Manila. With over **3 million college students** and **1.82 million IT-BPM professionals** competing for affordable housing, the current reliance on unregulated listings and social media groups leaves renters exposed to scams, poor conditions, and unreliable transactions.

This mobile-first platform connects students, young professionals, and urban workers with verified dorms, condos, and apartments through secure listings, digital contracts, and integrated e-wallet payments. Metro Stay eliminates the stress and risk of informal rentals by offering smart search filters, real-time landlord responsiveness tracking, bundled services (e.g., moving, cleaning), and proactive customer support.

The app is backed by a business model that combines commission-based revenue, premium subscriptions, listing upgrades, and local partnerships. Supported by a solid environmental and market analysis using the PESTEL and Porter's frameworks, Metro Stay is positioned as a disruptive force in the proptech sector—one that blends convenience, trust, and digital innovation to improve the renting experience for all.

Metro Stay has already developed its MVP (Minimum Viable Product), formed strategic partnerships, and projected clear growth milestones for the next three years. With a strong team handling development, compliance, financials, and UX, the platform is ready to scale—starting with students and workers in Metro Manila and expanding nationwide.

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INTRODUCTION

2.1 Background Of The Study

A growing number of students and young professionals are relocating to metropolitan areas such as Metro Manila for educational and employment opportunities. Enrollment for the IT-BPM sector was at an all-time high in 2023. The number of college students reached 3 million, while the total enrollment for college and vocational education was 17.3 million, and the IT-BPM sector employed 1.82 million professionals .The IT-BPM sector alone employed 1.82 million professionals. There is great need for affordable housing, and most rentals are still found through unregulated channels like Facebook or referrals, which leads to scamming, poor conditions, and unreliable transactions.

2.2 Purpose and Impact of the Project

Our goal is to innovate the chaotic and unregulated rental industry into a cohesive, safe, and digital one. The rental market suffers from rampant rental scams, limitations of cash-based systems, and unreliable listings. Metro Stay solves these issues by providing verified long-term accommodations to students and city workers. With features such as authenticated listings, digital contracts, and integrated e-wallet payments, the platform enhances safety and efficiency. This not only streamlines the rental process for tenants and landlords, but also fosters long-term trust, transparency, and sustainable access to housing in regions with high demand.

2.3 Scope and Limitations

Metro Stay centres on securing long-term leases for students and early-career workers in major Philippine cities, chiefly Metro Manila. Transactions occur solely through a mobile app available on Android devices. Because of this, the service reaches only users who:

- Own connected gadgets
- Pay digitally with confidence
- And sustain a steady internet link

Metro Stay, moreover, operates within each locality's rental and data-privacy rules, which may differ from one barangay to the next. At present, the platform does not list short-term stays or high-end properties.

PROBLEM STATEMENT & MARKET ANALYSIS

3.1 Identified Real-World Problem

In the Philippines, the rental housing market still operates largely outside formal channels, leaving students and young workers who relocate to cities facing a patchy, fragmented, and often risky system. Because well-organized rental websites are rare, newcomers rely on Facebook groups, word of mouth, or old-school classifieds to find a room or apartment. Such an approach opens the door to fake listings, money skimming, exaggerated photos, and dwellings that fail basic safety standards. The absence of standardized online payments and written lease records adds extra hassle, exposes renters to sudden price changes, and fuels unresolved disputes with landlords.

3.2 Target Market Overview

Metro Stay caters mainly to three groups:

1. Students
2. Young urban professionals
3. Landlord

During the 2023-2024 school year, the Philippines logged more than three million college enrollees, and a large portion is moving to cities like Metro Manila. At the same time, roughly 1.82 million workers in the booming IT-BPM sector are adding further pressure to the housing market. Additional possible users are returning Overseas Filipino Workers (OFWs), people looking into co-living or shared spaces, and landlords wanting dependable tenants through a well-managed service.

3.3 Market Needs and Pain Points

After extensive field surveys, interviews, and statistical reviews, researchers pinpointed the following clear yet layered needs and hurdles:

Market Needs

- Verified and Reliable Listings: Tenants expect listings that have been double-checked and refreshed on a regular schedule, so they can pick safe, fitting units without second-guessing.
- Convenient Digital Payment Options: Renters want straightforward, secure cashless methods-GCash, Maya, or regular bank transfers-built into the platform, cutting out extra steps at every rent cycle.
- Transparent Communication and Rating Systems: Clear chat records and a full landlord-tenant rating board give both sides the proof they need, turning guesswork into trust and holding everyone accountable.

- Bundled Move-in and Lifestyle Services: One-stop help with moving trucks, deep cleaning, budget furniture, Wi-Fi setups, and early utility links lets newcomers settle in without the usual mess.
- Proactive Support and Dispute Mediation: Fast, friendly channels that jump on maintenance calls, late payments, or other contract puzzles keep the arrangement running smoothly and cool tempers before they flare.

Pain Points

- Unverified and Fraudulent Listings: Tenants frequently encounter fake ads or poorly represented properties, forcing them to waste time and money while compounding personal anxiety.
- Limited Payment Flexibility: Cash-based transfers leave renters scrambling for receipts, uncertain about the exact state of their finances, and exposed to sudden dishonest claims.
- Poor Communication and Lack of Transparency: Slow, unclear messages from landlords breed frustration that escalates into misunderstandings, disputes, and broken expectations.
- Absence of Integrated Moving Assistance: Relocating renters must patch together movers, furniture, cleaning crews, and utility setups on their own, multiplying stress and cost.
- Hidden and Unexpected Fees: Unexplained extras-such as maintenance charges, deposits, or association dues-jump on renters mid-lease and throw budgets off track.
- Weak Data Privacy Protection: Informal rental websites and messaging apps often skimp on security, endangering personal data and leaving both parties open to identity theft.
- Limited Accessibility and Inclusivity: Most search tools overlook the needs of disabled individuals, pet owners, or tenants with specific health concerns, shutting them out of viable options.

3.4 Environmental Analysis

In this analysis, will examine outside forces shaping Metro Stays operations by applying two respected strategic models: PESTEL and Porter's Five Forces. The PESTEL lens first surveys Political, Economic, Social, Technological, Environmental, and Legal factors that could alter the business landscape. Porter's model then probes competitive dynamics, considering the threat of new market entrants, buyer and supplier bargaining power, substitute goods, and direct industry rivalry. By blending these tools, the analysis uncovers opportunities and risks alike, guiding Metro Stay toward sound, evidence-based planning and decision-making.

3.4.1 Pestel Framework

Politics Factors:

- Rent Control Act (RA 9653)
  - Annual rent hikes for residential units priced below the market cap are capped at roughly 7 percent.
  - Metro Manila Stay is tasked with monitoring these listings and enforcing the ceiling.
- Local Government Regulations
  - Hostels, boarding houses, and dorms must obtain permits from the barangay and city hall. Operators also have to meet fire, structural, and sanitation rules in the Fire Code and Building Code.
- Supportive Environment for Digital Platforms
  - New legislation-possibly the Internet Transactions Act-could soon mandate platform registration and basic consumer safeguards.
- Data Privacy Requirements
  - Businesses must obey the 2012 Data Privacy Act; violations can trigger fines of up to ₱5 million.

Economy Factors:

- Current Rental Market Situation
  - Condo rents across Metro Manila have dipped to a 15-year low because too many units now sit empty.
  - Vacancy rates hover around 17-19 percent, giving renters plenty of choice but leaving owners with cash-flow headaches.
- Rising Demand Despite Low Prices
  - Urban migration shows no sign of slowing; students and young professionals continue to flood into the capital. An estimated 1.82 million BPO employees will be on payroll in 2024, and GDP growth of 5-7 percent underpins stable demand.
- Fintech and Digital Payments Growth
  - The Philippines digital payments scene is on track to exceed $107 billion by 2025, reshaping everyday transactions.
- Consistent Market Churn
  - More than 3.2 million college students and new graduates migrate to urban centers each year, keeping the pipeline constant.
- Overall Insight
  - Falling prices widen the user base but squeeze the commissions Metro Stay earns on

each booking. Yet resilient long-term demand and the rise of digital habits still position the service as an attractive option for both tenants and landlords.

Social Factors:

- Urban Migration and Cultural Focus on Education/Careers
  - Close to half (48.5%) of Filipinos now call a city home, and the numbers will keep rising as people relocate for study or work.
  - Many first-time renters are youthful, still learning their way around, and need housing that is quick to find and easy to reach. Rentals are often secured through family, friends, or lively Facebook Group chats.
- Reliance on Informal Networks
  - Although rooted in trust, this practice can funnel victims into scams or listings that were never real.
  - Metro Stay proposes a verified marketplace that turns shaky word-of-mouth into a safer digital handshake.
- High Social Media and App Usage
  - Roughly 73.4% of Filipinos spend over three hours a day on social platforms.
  - Most are at ease using apps to buy goods, book rides, or arrange repairs-housing seems a natural next step.
- Shift Toward Co-living
  - Young renters are increasingly willing to split rent and chores, whether in dorms or shared apartments.
- Young, Digitally Savvy Segment
  - The Philippines median age is 25.1 years, with around 28 percent between 18 and 34-the prime audience for Metro Stay.
  - This group seeks speedy, low-cost, app-driven services yet demands reliable security and everyday convenience.

Technological Factors:

- High Smartphone and Internet Use
  - About 64.7 million Filipinos own smartphones, and mobile data is everywhere.
  - Nearly all online users-99%-connect via phones, so apps are the natural choice. Metro Stays app-first approach matches how its audience already behaves.
- Boom in Digital Payments
  - E-wallets, especially GCash, attract huge numbers; 2023 counts show 81 million users. Total accounts exceed 393 million because many people load multiple wallets.

- Cloud and Platform Readiness
    - The country's cloud network and data centers keep expanding and maturing. Reliable back-end support lets Metro Stay run smoothly and grow when needed.
- Advanced Features Are Possible
    - Users already handle maps, GPS, and even AR/VR when searching online.
    - Metro Stay can plug in these tools later without major rewrites.
- Tech-Savvy Competition Exists
    - Rental rivals-Lamudi, Rentpad, Dormy-use digital features to capture markets.
- Cybersecurity is Non-Negotiable:
    - As online bookings rise, safeguarding personal information has become vital.
    - Metro Stay must shield payments and protect guest privacy through encryption and two-factor authentication.

Environment:

- Urban Traffic and Commute Issues
    - Metro Manila routinely ranks among the world's most congested urban centers. Many renters now choose residences within walking distance of school or work to escape punishing travel times.
- Housing Shortage vs. Oversupply
    - An ongoing deficit of affordable rooms leaves students and entry-level workers scrambling for shelter.
    - Simultaneously, numerous new condominiums sit empty because monthly fees remain beyond most budgets.
- Natural Disasters and Safety Concerns
    - Floods, typhoons, and quakes are routine realities for most Philippine communities. Savvy renters now prioritize structural integrity and disaster preparedness in every lease.
- Eco-Conscious and Disaster-Ready Living
    - A growing segment seeks homes that balance comfort, sustainability, and resilience to climate shocks. Metro Stay highlights green-certified projects, elevated low-rise dwellings, and other earth-friendly options.
- Post-Disaster Support
    - Storms and quakes can instantly render units uninhabitable, forcing families to move on short notice. The platform's real-time feed allows displaced renters to secure replacement lodging in hours rather than days.

Legal Factors :

- Rental Laws and Landlord-Tenant Rules
    - Philippine law protects renters, so landlords must give real notice and follow due-process steps before any eviction.
    - When conflict arises, parties first turn to barangay mediation; only after that can the case go to court.
- Data Privacy and Platform Responsibilities
    - Under the Data Privacy Act (RA 10173), Metro Stay must secure user data, collect consent, and probably register with the National Privacy Commission.
    - To avoid fines, the firm may need a full-time Data Protection Officer on the payroll.
- E-Commerce and Online Regulation
    - When the Internet Transactions Act takes effect, hubs like Metro Stay will probably have to:
        - register with the DTI
        - team up with enforcement agencies during fraud probes
        - Metro Stay should prepare now for these tighter rules.
- Payments, Taxes, and Contracts
    - If the platform collects rent, it may also partner with firms licensed by the Bangko Sentral to clear funds legally.
    - Because landlords owe tax on rental income, the platform ought to remind them of that duty or offer simple tools for compliance.
    - Electronic signatures and web-based contracts hold up in Philippine courts.
    - Tenants younger than eighteen usually need a parent or guardian to co-sign the lease.
- Liability, Insurance, and Ownership
    - Embed a clear liability waiver in the terms of use.
    - Think about providing, or teaming with a partner to offer, renters insurance and fraud protection.
    - State plainly who owns uploaded content-photos, listings, and the like-to prevent copyright disputes.

3.4.2 Porter's Five Forces Model

Threat Of New Entrant(Moderate)

- Real-world proof ventures such as Dormy PH illustrate how niche-focused newcomers can carve out space.
- Key hurdles, Trust formation and a critical mass of users and listings must align, or neither side

stays.

- Formidable rivals, Established platforms such as Lamudi possess deeper pockets and brand clout, hindering fresh entrants.
- First-mover edge, Metro Stay can solidify early loyalty, introduce standout features, and build trust within the student-and-worker niche.
- Overall assessment, Risk is moderate-entry is easy, yet scaling demands rigorous execution, strong leadership and adaptive operations.

Bargaining Power Of Buyer(High)

- Individual renters possess little power because a single voice cannot shape policies or pricing decisions.
- Together, however, they gain leverage; high vacancy rates around 17 to 19 percent allow renters to negotiate terms or walk away from listings that appear unfavorable.
- Metro Stays review and rating system lets tenants spot unreliable landlords before signing a lease.
- Alternative channels, such as Facebook groups or broker referrals, further enhance bargaining strength; if Metro Stay fails to deliver, renters can simply pivot to another option.
- Yet collective behavior and public reviews still influence industry norms; repeated poor ratings for a landlord translate into dwindling tenant interest.
- Taken together, renter bargaining power on Metro Stay remains high but pronounced when considered in terms of service quality and platform accountability. To keep its user base, Metro Stay must place renter satisfaction at the center of its business model.

Bargaining Power Of Supplier(Low To Moderate)

- Landlords can promote their properties on other sites-Facebook, Lamudi and the like-so leaving Metro Stay costs them little and gives them extra bargaining power.
- Surplus listings and high vacancy rates, however, undermine that power; many hosts now need tenants more than Metro Stay needs their inventory.
- Small landlords thus grow reliant on the platform when it supplies a steady stream of leads they might struggle to generate elsewhere.
- In contrast, larger suppliers such as developers command attention and often negotiate exclusives, bulk listings, or special marketing terms.
- This multi-homing behavior-placing the same unit on several portals-limits any single platform control and keeps landlords options open.
- Should Metro Stay achieve widespread dominance, hosts might feel locked in, yet at present their bargaining strength varies:

    - Very high for owners with sought-after, well-located units or large portfolios.
    - Weak for individual landlords in oversaturated neighborhoods.

Threat Of Substitutes(High)

- Common Substitutes:
    - Facebook Groups and Marketplace - Free, popular, but scams appear weekly.
    - Traditional brokers - Face-to-face guidance near schools and offices, yet commissions bite.
    - Other platforms - Rentpad, Dormy, Lamudi, Carousell and Property24 already host listings and traffic.
- Why These Matter:
    - Most options are familiar, easy to use and cheap.

Competitive Rivalry(Moderate)

- Competition in the Philippine online rental arena is somewhat fierce for several reasons:
    - First, a number of established generalist platforms already command user trust:
        - Rentpad focuses exclusively on rentals and has built its reputation since 2013.
        - Lamudi boasts broad user reach, brokers screen listings, and is known for both sales and lease ads.
- Beyond these general portals, a wave of niche challengers is carving out specific segments:
    - Dormy PH, sister firm to Metro Stay, zeroes in on student and co-living units and markets aggressively via social feeds.
    - Unregulated channels blur the lines between substitute and direct rivalry, as Facebook groups and informal brokers circulate offers outside formal platforms. Because switching costs are almost nil-users download as many applications as they please-long-term customer loyalty remains precarious.

PROPOSED SOLUTION & VALUE PROPOSITION

4.1 Product Service Description

Metro Stay is a digital rental platform aimed at students, early-career professionals, and other city renters seeking secure, budget-friendly, and longer-term housing across key Philippine metros. Through a straightforward mobile app and website, the service links verified landlords and property managers with prospective occupants, providing:

- Verified listings complete with property documents and IDs
- Smart filters for distance to school or office, price, and amenities
- In-app leasing featuring e-signatures and stored contracts
- Security based digital payments via GCash, Maya, or banks
- Roommate matching plus bundled moving, furniture, and cleaning services
- Ratings, reviews, and real-time tracking of landlord responsiveness

4.2 Innovation And Unique Selling Points

Metro Stay differentiates itself from competitors through:

- **Safety-first design**: Verified landlord identities, property inspections, secured for deposits
- **Student and young professionals focused targeting**: Filters for campus/work hubs, short- and mid-term stay options
- **Bundled services**: Integrated moving assistance, cleaning, and furniture rentals
- **Trust-building system**: Landlord and renter ratings, responsiveness scores, dispute mediation
- **Digital-native features**: Mobile-first interface, e-signature contracts, QR rent payments
- **Multi-party flexibility**: Roommate-matching, shared rentals, and co-living options

4.3 Benefits To Customers

For renters:

- Avoid scams through verified, trusted listings
- Cashless payments and secured reduce financial risk
- Easier to find affordable housing near schools or offices
- Transparent communication with landlords
- Save time and stress with all-in-one bundled services
- Feel safer with a professional platform that handles support and dispute resolution

For landlords:

- Reach target renters (students, urban workers) efficiently
- Fill vacancies faster, especially in oversupplied markets
- Use standardized lease tools, automated payments, and digital support.

BUSINESS MODEL CANVAS

5.1 Customer Segments

University students needing affordable and secured housing near campuses: Students looking for safe, cost-effective homes near schools.

Fresh graduates and young professional workers in Metro Manila: Young workers needing reliable urban housing.

Condo/apartment landlords looking to fill vacant units: Owners eager to find tenants quickly.

Dormitory/boarding house owners targeting student renters: Providers of shared student accommodations.

Local services seeking steady clientele: Businesses providing related services (cleaning, moving).

5.2 Value Propositions

Convenient, secure long-term rental search tailored for students and urban professionals: Makes finding a safe and affordable rental easier.

Verified, scam-free listings reducing risk and uncertainty: Ensures rentals listed are genuine, not scams.

Easy online booking and payments with secured protection: Allows paying rent securely online with money protection.

Transparent landlord reviews and ratings: Helps users pick good landlords based on feedback.

Bundled value-added services (moving, cleaning, furniture rentals): Offers extra services to simplify the moving process.

Responsive customer support and conflict resolution assistance: Quick help with any rental-related issues.

5.3 Channels

Mobile app: Primary way users interact with Metro Stay.

Social media: Using platforms like Facebook and Instagram to reach potential users.

Campus and university partnerships: Collaborations with schools to directly engage students.

SEO-optimized blog for housing advice and student living tips: Helpful content that brings users to Metro Stay.

Digital marketing: Online advertisements and promotions.

Offline promotions: Traditional advertising methods like flyers, events, or posters.

5.4 Customer Relationship.

In-app customer support: Assistance directly available within the app

User ratings and feedback system: Lets tenants and landlords review each other openly.

Personalized notifications and reminders: Alerts for rent payments, lease renewals, etc.

Community engagement: Opportunities to connect with others, such as forums or groups.

Loyalty programs and rewards: Special discounts or benefits for regular or loyal users.

5.5 Revenue Streams

Commission fees: A small fee from each successful rental payment.

Listing fees: Charges for landlords who want to feature their listings prominently.

Premium renter subscriptions: Fees from renters for special privileges or exclusive access.

Value-added service commissions: Earnings from extra services (cleaning, moving).

Advertising and sponsorship from local businesses: Payments from businesses advertised on the platform.

Affiliate marketing with partner businesses: Earnings from referring users to partner services like groceries or utilities.

5.6 Key Resources

User-friendly mobile app: An easy-to-use app that tenants and landlords can access anywhere.

Secure, scalable cloud infrastructure: Reliable tech that handles large numbers of users without issues.

Verified listings and landlord databases: A safe list of trusted landlords and properties.

Customer support team: Staff ready to assist users with their concerns and questions.

Data analytics for market insights: Tools to understand what renters and landlords need.

Strong brand and reputation: Positive public image that makes users trust Metro Stay.

5.7 Key Activities

Platform development and maintenance: Building and updating the Metro Stay app.

Listing verification and moderation: Checking rental listings to ensure they are real and safe.

Tenant-landlord matching: Helping tenants find the best landlords and roommates.

Payment processing and secured management: Handling rent payments securely online.

Marketing and user acquisition: Promoting Metro Stay to attract more users.

Customer support and dispute resolution: Helping solve problems between tenants and landlords quickly.

5.8 Key Partnerships

Platform development and maintenance: Building and updating the Metro Stay app.

Listing verification and moderation: Checking rental listings to ensure they are real and safe.

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5.9 Cost Structure

Commission fees: A small fee from each successful rental payment.

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SCALING AND GROWTH STRATEGY

6.1 Market Penetration

Campus Launch Campaigns

- Identify and target five key universities in Metro Manila based on student population and housing demand.
- Conduct on-site events during orientation week and move-in periods with branded booths, demo stations, and sign-up incentives (e.g., free three-day premium access).
- Distribute QR-coded flyers and offer “first-come” booking fee waivers for students who register within 48 hours of the event.

Corporate Outreach Programs

- Partner with three large employers (e.g., tech firms, call centers, multinational companies) to include Metro Stay in their relocation and onboarding materials.
- Provide company-specific discount codes and a dedicated “Metro Stay for [Company Name]” portal landing page.
- Organize quarterly “Housing Fairs” at partner offices where employees can meet verified landlords, view sample listings, and get on-the-spot assistance.

Digital Marketing & Performance Channels

- Run segmented Facebook and Instagram ad campaigns targeting “students in Metro Manila” and “urban professionals aged 22–35” with carousel ads showcasing popular listings and success stories.
- Invest in search-engine marketing for keywords like “affordable student housing Manila” and “long-term rental app,” aiming for a click-through rate (CTR) > 3%.
- Deploy retargeting pixels to re-engage website visitors with personalized offers (e.g., “5 new listings near your campus!”).

Referral & Ambassador Program

- Recruit 20 “Campus Ambassadors” (student leaders, housing coordinators) and 10 “Corporate Ambassadors” (HR contacts, relocation specialists) who earn ₱300 credit per successful referral tenant or landlord.
- Implement automated referral tracking and notifications within the app to drive peer-to-peer

sign-ups.

- Host monthly leaderboard competitions with prizes (e.g., gadgets, gift cards) to sustain ambassador engagement.

6.2 Strategic Partnership

University Housing Offices

- Secure formal memorandum of understanding with at least three major institutions (e.g., University of the Philippines, Ateneo, De La Salle) to become their **official housing partner**.
- Integrate Metro Stay into each school's housing portal and student orientation site, with "Metro Stay Verified" badges on partner listings.
- Co-produce quarterly webinars or on-campus seminars on "Safe Renting Practices" co-branded with the university's Student Affairs or Housing Office.

Corporate Relocation & HR Departments

- Establish agreements with two multinational companies and two large local corporations to embed Metro Stay into their **new-hire relocation packages**.
- Offer dedicated account managers to coordinate large-volume needs and guarantee response service level agreement (e.g., property proposals within 24 hours).
- Provide customizable corporate dashboards showing employee booking progress, spending reports, and satisfaction ratings.

Service Providers & Local SMEs

- Onboard two vetted moving companies and two furniture rental firms under revenue-share agreements, delivering **exclusive "Move-in Bundles"** at predefined rates.
- Partner with one national cleaning service chain to offer **post-move-in cleaning** and monthly maintenance subscriptions.
  Integrate utility setup services (electricity, internet, water) via partnerships with major providers, enabling tenants to apply directly within the app.

Financial & Insurance Institutions

- Collaborate with GCash and Maya to implement **zero-fee rent payments** for the first six months, and promote these offers through both platform and partner channels.
- Pilot a renters' insurance product with a leading insurer offering **the first month free** and

seamless in-app claims handling.

- Develop co-branded financial education content (e.g., budgeting guides for renters) distributed via partner newsletters and the Metro Stay blog.

Government and Regulatory Bodies

- Engage the Department of Trade and Industry (DTI) to ensure Metro Stay's marketplace compliance, seeking a "Trustmark" accreditation once the Internet Transactions Act is enacted.
- Consult with the National Privacy Commission (NPC) to establish best-practice data protection protocols and achieve a "Privacy by Design" certification.
- Participate in joint public-private housing initiatives aimed at reducing the student housing backlog, positioning Metro Stay as a socially responsible stakeholder.

6.3 Key Growth Milestones

Timeline	Milestone	KPI Target	Key Activities
Year 1 (0-12 Months) - Launch Phase	Prove demand in Metro Manila	**Total Users: 500** 300 standard renters 200 student renters	Launch GCash/PayMaya payment integration
		Active Listings: 80 (50 verified)	Offer "1st month free" premium listings to landlords
		Partnerships: 1 university 1 moving service provider	
Year 2 (13-24 Months) - Growth Phase	Optimize unit economics	**Total Users: 1,500** 800 standard renters 700 student renters	Expand to 2 new universities
		Active Listings: 300 (200 verified)	Launch landlord referral program
		New Initiatives: Renters' insurance (5% adoption)	

		Utilities package (electricity + WiFi)	
Year 3 (25-36 Months) - Scale Phase	Metro Manila dominance	**Total Users: 3,000** 1,500 standard renters 1,500 student renters	Partner with 3 corporate clients for employee housing
		Active Listings: 800 (600 verified)	
		Revenue Drivers: 20% premium listing uptake 15% insurance adoption	

FUNDING STRATEGY & FINANCIAL PROJECTIONS

7.1 Potential Funding Sources

Angel Investor Round

Target Investors:

- Philippine Angels Network (Avg. ticket: ₱2M-₱5M)
- Founder Institute Manila (Pre-seed funding)
- Local Proptech VCs (e.g., Kickstart Ventures)

Government & University Grants

Philippine-Specific Options:

- DTI Startup Grant Program (Up to ₱500k for tech innovations) *Requirement: SEC-registered corp. + MVP*
- DOST PCIEERD (Funds proptech solutions)
- University Partnerships (Example: DLSU's Animo Labs incubator offers ₱200k + office space)

7.2 Capital Outlay

Financial - Google Sheets

7.1 3-Year Financial Projections(Profit & Loss)

Financial - Google Sheets

TECHNOLOGY INNOVATION

8.1 Description of Emerging Technology

- Verified Digital Listings and Property Moderation System
  - Validation of identity and other documents alongside image verification and machine learning technologies. This technology addresses informal market fraud and misleading listings by providing robust verification, enabling the creation of a trusted digital space for transactions and increasing online user activity.
- Integrated Digital Payments (E-wallet Integration)
  - Local digital payments like GCash payments offer seamless e-wallet integration. This integration addresses issues of slow, unsafe, and inefficient rental transactions associated with cash payments or manual bank deposits. It also enables escrow payments, securing transactions in a way informal or traditional methods do not.
- Data Analytics and Market Insights
  - Utilizes sophisticated data analytics systems to monitor and track market activity, formulate optimum rental rates, and assess users' behavioral patterns and preferences. Equips them with thorough analyses to set competitive rental rates and devise effective marketing strategies. Empowers renters with real-time insights and, thus, enhances market transparency for more informed decisions.

8.2 Prototype, Demo, Simulation

SCAN ME

Scan to download .apk file

TEAMS AND ROLES

Business Lead & Financial Strategist
Jacob Conrad Mercado Quendangan

Main Roles:
- **Programmer:** Codes the core Metro Stay application using Android Studio (Kotlin), Firebase (database) and Cloudinary (free for image uploads).
- **Financial Manager:** Tracks capital outlay, project costs, and long-term revenue targets.
- **Business Developer:** Leads partnership building with landlords, local government units (LGUs), and universities.

Contributions:
- Designed the business model and initial revenue projections.
- Created the pitch deck and handled key financial documents and legal registrations.
- Drafted partnership proposals for school housing boards and dorm owners.

Strengths: Great with numbers, and detail-oriented with paperworks.

Lead Developer & Technical Architect

Mhikaela Galo

Main Roles:

- **System Integrator:** Sets up e-wallet APIs (e.g., GCash/Maya) and cloud database connections.
- **Compliance Lead:** Researches legal regulations (Data Privacy Act, Rent Control), ensures terms of use and app flow are compliant.
- **Security & Infrastructure Lead:** Implements log-in systems, safety logic, and server hosting.

Contributions:
- Built the MVP (Minimum Viable Product) of the app, including account creation, listing upload, and search filters
- Developed the smart-matching algorithm logic for co-living suggestions.
  Integrated a basic document upload and digital signing feature for e-leases.

Strengths: Tech-savvy, organized, works quietly but gets things done fast.

UX/UI Designer & Compliance Coordinator
Jerielle Marcha Pingol
Main Roles:

- **Designer:** Creates all app layouts, button flows, and visual assets.
- **Pitch Lead:** Handles investor relations, pricing strategy, and startup documentation.
- **User Advocate:** Conducts feedback sessions, surveys, and social engagement tracking.

Contributions:

- Designed all wireframes and branding for Metro Stay.
- Created a clean, youth-friendly interface tested on student users.
- Wrote the initial privacy policy draft and terms of service outline.

Strengths: Creative, people-oriented, handles both design and light policy work with care.

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